Interview Prep Tracker

Application Reference Document

Personal Learning Dashboard for Interview Preparation

Version 0.1 • October 2026

1. Purpose

This application turns interview preparation from a private, hard-to-measure activity into a structured, timestamp-driven, and showcase-able journey. It is designed especially for people transitioning from Manual QA (or other roles) into Software Development roles. Instead of posting “I studied Java today”, the user maintains a living dashboard of sessions, confidence levels, DSA problems, revision items, notes, and performance scores.

2. Goals for v1

• Personal dashboard only (private by default)

• Learning session logging with rich fields

• Real-time study timer linked to timestamps

• Performance scoring based on actual duration + confidence + consistency

• Notes (self-messaging) and short blog/reflection pages

• Dark mode + fully responsive (mobile + web)

• Clean, modern card-based UI preferred by 20-something job seekers

• Auth with Auth.js (email/password + optional GitHub)

3. Must-have Learning Log Fields

Field	Example / Notes
Title	Java Constructors deep dive
Topic	Java constructors
Category	JAVA / DSA / DBMS / OS / SYSTEM_DESIGN / ...
Date	Auto or date picker
Duration (minutes)	90 (source of truth for scoring)
Concepts Covered	default, parameterized, private
Practice Notes	Wrote examples + factory method
Key Takeaway	Private constructor restricts instantiation
Confidence	LEARNING → PRACTICED → REVISION → INTERVIEW_READY
Revision Needed	true / false (feeds revision queue)
Next Step	Implement utility class with private ctor

Score Points	Auto-calculated by business logic

4. Performance Scoring Logic

All scoring uses real timestamps (startedAt, endedAt, createdAt, session date). This prevents gaming the system by simply typing numbers.

• Base points = durationMinutes / 10

• Confidence multipliers: LEARNING ×1.0 • PRACTICED ×1.3 • REVISION ×1.6 • INTERVIEW_READY ×2.0

• Streak bonus: +5 points when the previous day also had a session

• Weekly consistency bonus: +15 points when the weekly goal is first crossed

5. Technology Stack

Next.js 15 (App Router) + TypeScript + Tailwind CSS + Prisma + PostgreSQL + Auth.js + Recharts + React Hook Form + Zod + Lucide icons

6. Recommended Local Setup

1. docker compose up -d (starts PostgreSQL)

2. cp .env.example .env and set AUTH_SECRET

3. npm install && npx prisma db push && npx prisma generate

4. npm run dev

7. Project Philosophy

One concept at a time. One commit at a time. The dashboard exists so that progress is visible, measurable, and honest — both to the user and to future interviewers.

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